

The Social Studies Writing Manual

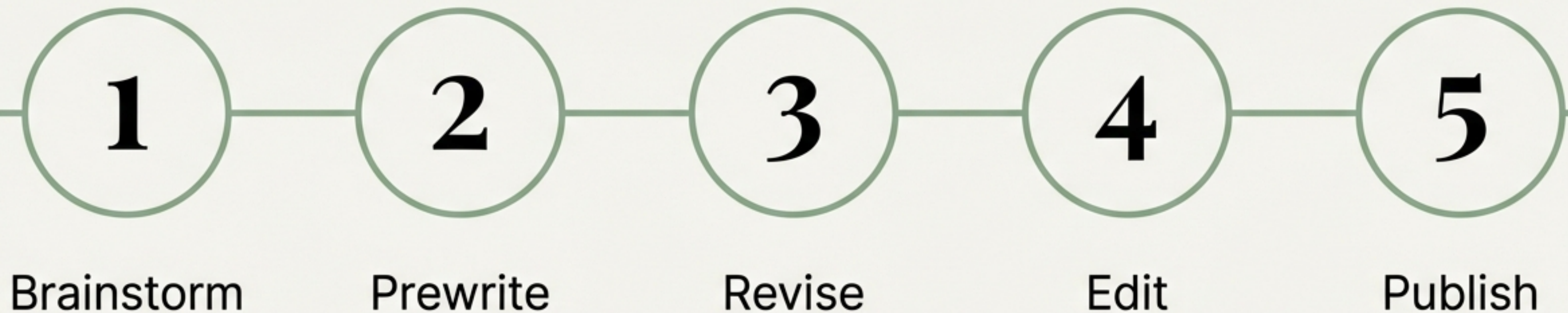
Standards for Academic Excellence & Composition



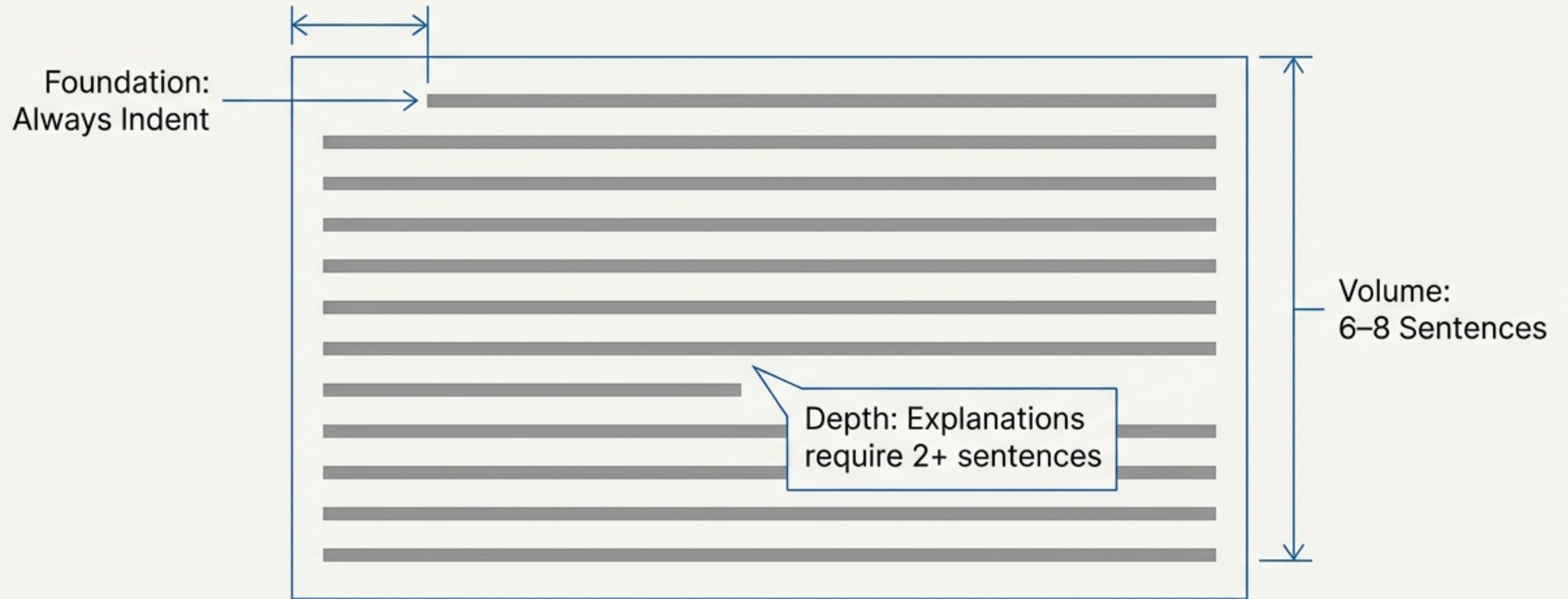
A comprehensive guide to the architecture, style, and mechanics required for the student scholar.

The Writing Lifecycle

Great papers are not written; they are rewritten. Adherence to the full writing process is required for every assignment.



The Architecture of a Paragraph



~~And~~
~~Because~~
~~So~~
~~Also~~
~~But~~
~~1990...~~
~~100...~~

Constructing Strong Openings

Eliminate weak conjunctions and numerals at the start of sentences.

Formal academic writing requires confident assertions. Never begin a sentence with weak conjunctions. Additionally, never start a sentence with a year or a number. Rephrase the sentence to place the figure inside.

Precision in Endings

Never end a sentence with a preposition phrase.
It leaves the thought incomplete.

above, across, against, along, among, around,
at, before, behind, below, beneath, beside,
between, by, down, from, in, into, near, of,
off, on, to, toward, under, upon, with, with,
wirer, upon

Eliminating Academic Clichés

The Cliché

- ~~This means...~~
- ~~In conclusion...~~
- ~~Finally (in conclusion)~~

The Fix

- Do not state the obvious. Explain the concept directly.
- Your final paragraph should be a conclusion based on content, not a label.
- Avoid filler words. State your point.

Usage Note: Be extremely careful and intentional with the words "that" and "then".

The Rule of Numbers

One	Two	Three	Four	Five	Six	Seven	Eight	Nine	Ten.	11
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	

Standard: Numbers 1 through 10 must be written out as words.
Reminder: Never begin a sentence with a digit, regardless of its value.

Punctuation Protocols

...ended
the war.”

The Classroom Code

1. Every sentence starts with a capital and ends with a period.
2. The period must be placed INSIDE the quotes.
3. A hyperlink is NOT a citation.

Digital Hygiene & Proofing

The final submitted document must be polished and error-free. If your software flags it, fix it or add it to the dictionary.

Lorem ipsum dolor uummt amet, recieve
nutching plan, wedding our consqumant
pinlunate, and definatly the mevarnine
putular maz of all it comerand hunno things,
in stilumpis, because seperate want it be
unserbered. It is in wonly, shell expansive



Maximum 3 Red
Underlines Allowed

The Quality Control Check

Two pairs of eyes are required before submission.



Step 1: Read Aloud

Catch rhythm and logic errors
your eyes might miss.



Step 2: Parent Review

Have a parent read the paper
over for logic and flow.

“Thank you for reading this.”

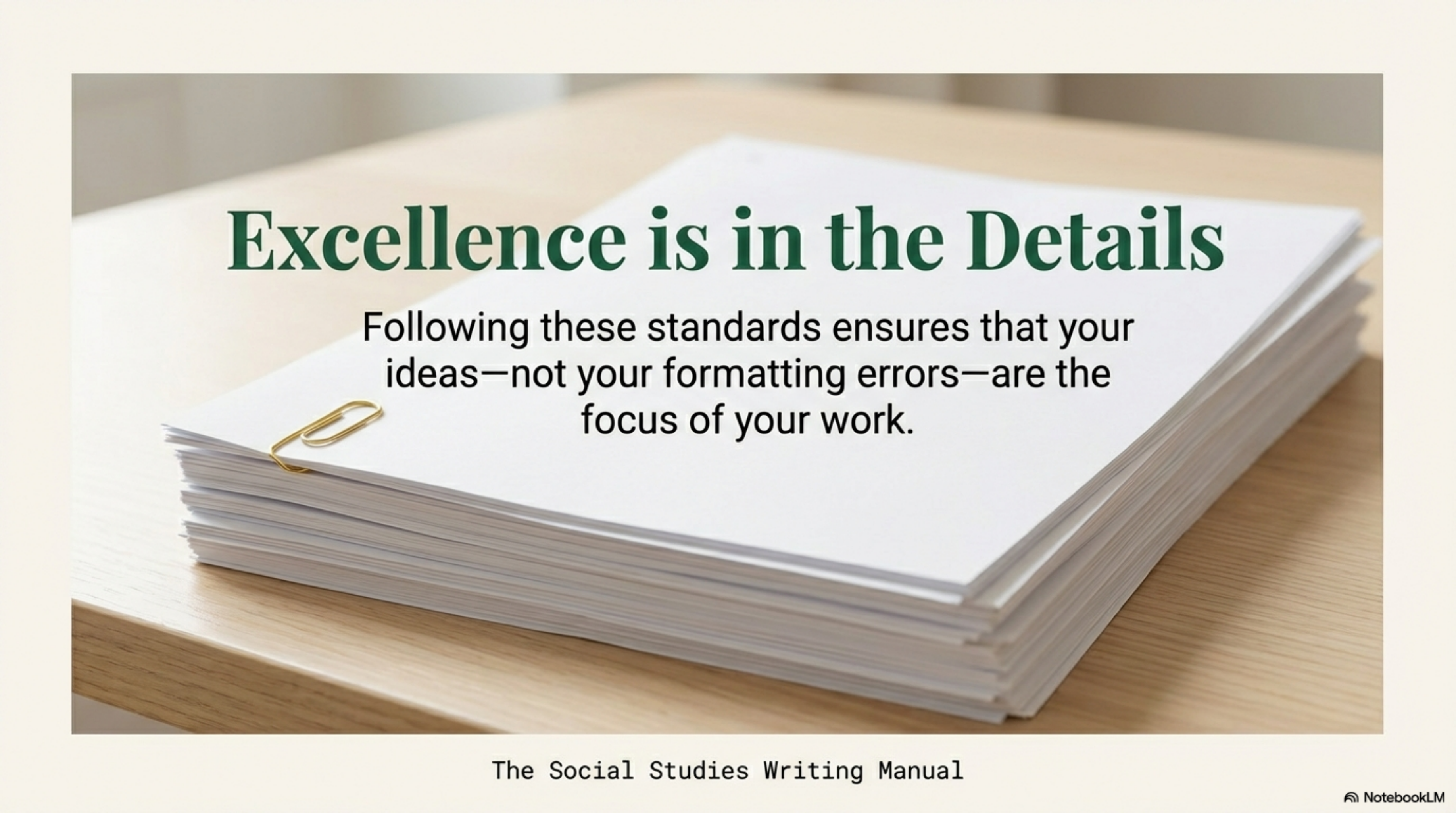
Pre-Submission Checklist

ALWAYS

- Indent first sentences.
- Write out numbers one through ten.
- Ensure paragraphs are 6-8 sentences.
- Ensure explanations are 2+ sentences.
- Read aloud & Parent proofread.

NEVER

- Start sentences with Conjunctions (And, But, So).
- Start sentences with Numbers.
- End sentences with Prepositions.
- Use clichés ('This means', 'In conclusion').
- Leave more than 3 red spell-check lines.
- Use hyperlinks as citations.

A stack of white papers is placed on a light-colored wooden desk. A gold paperclip is attached to the top left corner of the stack. The text is overlaid on the papers.

Excellence is in the Details

Following these standards ensures that your ideas—not your formatting errors—are the focus of your work.